MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FORCEPS, TISSUE, BROWN AND BROWN-ADSON

This specification is approved for use by Defense Personnel Support Center, Defense Logistics Agency, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers tweezer tissue forceps suitable for grasping and holding tissue securely with minimum pressure and trauma.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and sizes. The forceps shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I. Brown-Adson.
  Size 1. 4-1/2 inch.

Type II. Brown.
  Size 1. 8-inch.
  Size 2. 6-inch.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

GG-I-526 Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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PPP-B-585 - Box, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601 - Box, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Box, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-No. 66 - Steel: Chemical Composition and Hardenability.
FED-STD-No. 151 - Metal, Test Methods.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards

E-18 Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials.

E-140 Standard Hardness Conversion Tables for Metals (Relationship between Brinell Hardness, Vickers Hardness, Rockwell Hardness, Rockwell Superfical Hardness and Knoop Hardness).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

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American Iron and Steel Institute (AISI).

Steel Products Manual.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Iron and Steel Institute, 1000 16th Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General requirements. The individual part requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526. In the event of any conflict between the requirements of GG-I-526 and those of this specifications, the latter shall govern.

3.2 Materials. The tissue forceps shall be fabricated from AISI type 420 stainless steel as specified in GG-I-526, except that the minimum carbon content may be 0.14 percent.

3.3 Design and construction. The instrument shall be a straight, spring type, side grasping tissue forceps of the Brown or Brown-Adson design as specified.

3.3.1 Teeth. The forceps shall be designed to provide multiple parallel teeth along the shank which shall mesh and fit closely without play. The meshing teeth shall be 7:7 for the Type I design and 8:8 for the Type II design.

3.3.2 Physical dimensions. The physical dimensions of the Type I instrument shall be in accordance with figure 1. Figure 2 delineates the type II design.

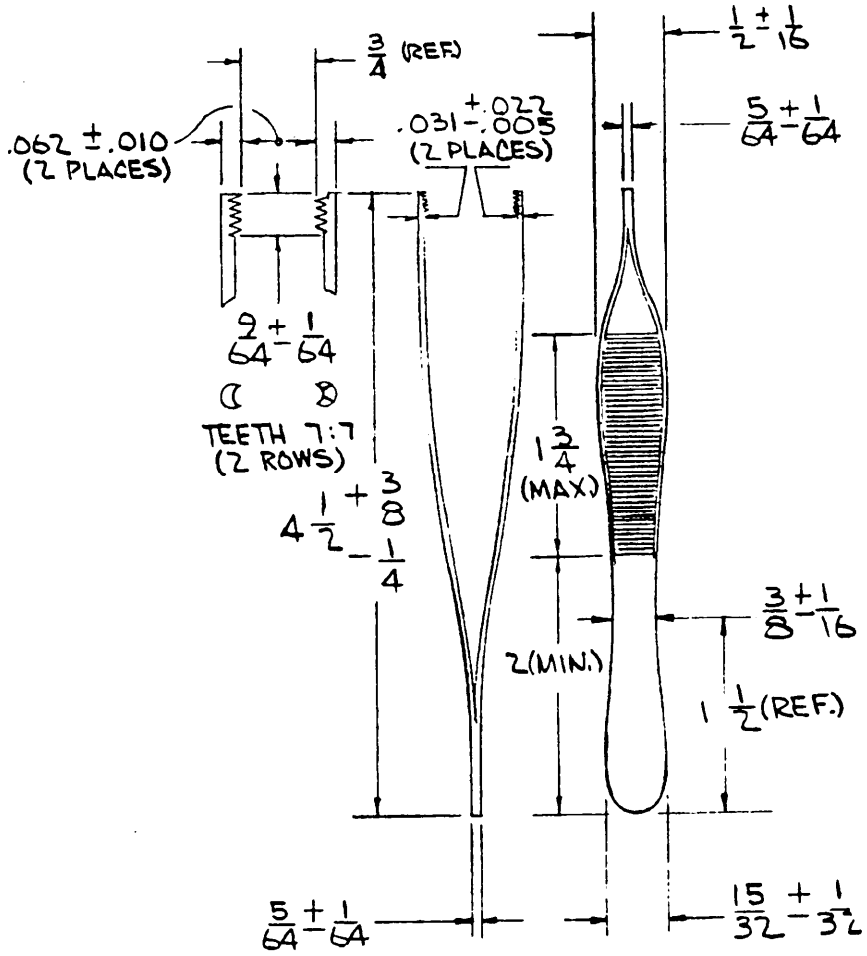
3.3.3 Hardness. When tested as specified in 4.5.1 the finished instrument shall have a Rockwell hardness of C40 minimum, after proper stress relieving.

3.3.4 Corrosion resistance. The instrument shall be corrosion resistant conforming with the requirements of GG-I-526 when tested as specified in 4.5.2.1 and 4.5.2.2.

3.4 Finish. The finished instrument shall have a mirror finish or a satin finish. Alternatively, the exterior surfaces of the instrument may have a mirror finish and a satin finish on the inside surface of the forcep halves.

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TYPE 1, SIZE 1



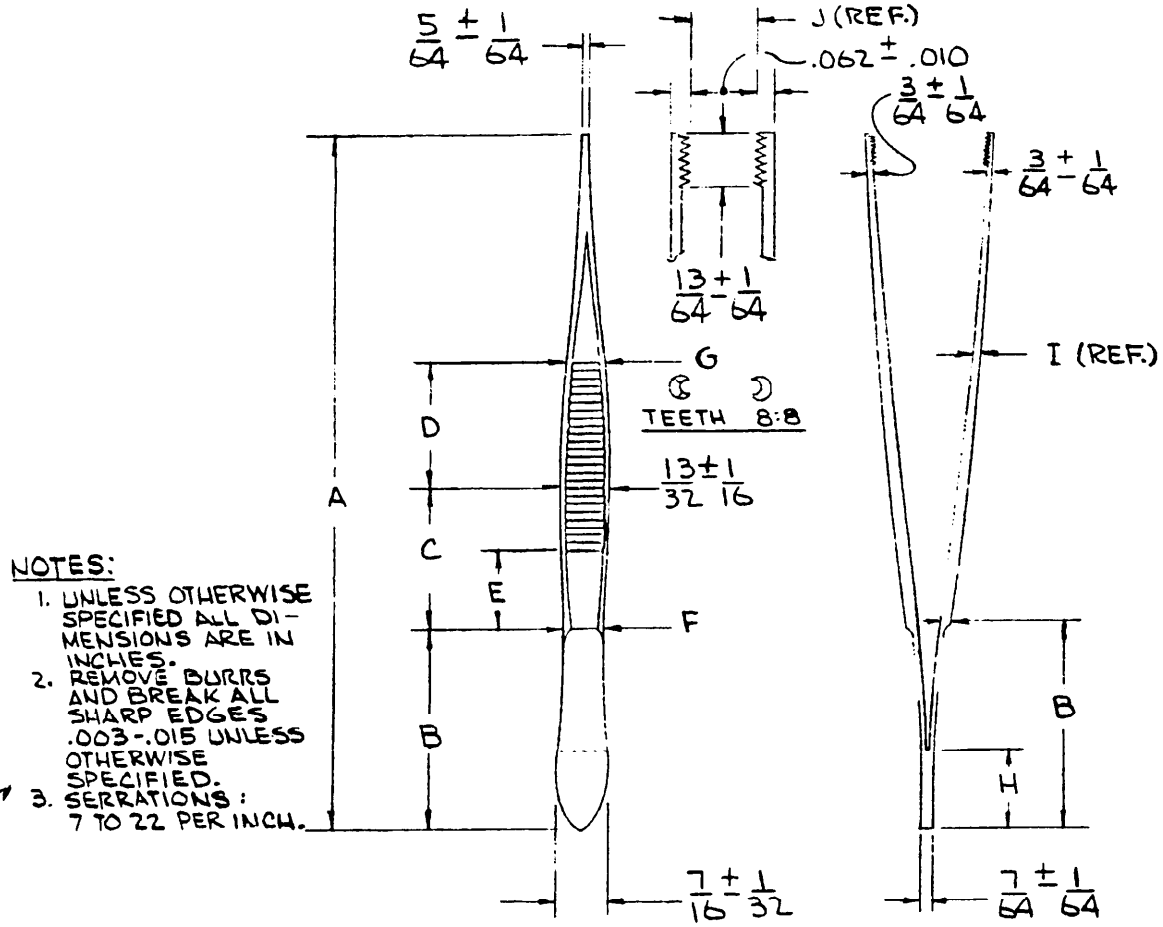
NOTE:

1. REMOVE BURRS AND BREAK ALL SHARP EDGES .003-.015 UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED.
2. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES.

FIGURE 1. Forceps, tissue, Brown-Adson.

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TYPE 2



NOTES:

1. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES.
2. REMOVE BURRS AND BREAK ALL SHARP EDGES .003-.015 UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED.
3. SERRATIONS: 7 TO 22 PER INCH.

NSN	DIMENSIONS										SIZE
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	
6515-00-584-3739	8	2	1-3/4	1-3/8	7/8	23/64	9/32	11/16	7/64	1-3/8	1
6515-00-584-3740	6	1-3/4	1-1/2	7/8	3/4	5/16	5/16	13/16	3/32	3/4	2
TOLERANCES (±)	1/4	1/8	1/16	1/16	1/8	1/32	1/32	1/16	1/64		

FIGURE 2. Forceps, tissue, Brown.

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3.4.1 Weld joint. There shall be no space or visible crevice between adjacent surfaces of the forcep halves in the area at which the two surfaces are attached.

3.4.2 Passivation. As a final finish operation the complete instrument shall be passivated.

3.5 Identification marking. Identification marking of finished instruments shall be in accordance with GG-I-526. In addition to the requirements specified, instruments of foreign manufacture shall also be marked "stainless".

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The instrument shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform in quality and shall be free from surface roughness, burns, pits, scale, corrosion, or any other defect that will affect life, serviceability or appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual, and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion resistant metals may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be

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4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion resistant metals may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificates shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Inspection lot. The inspection lot shall be determined in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2 Sampling for visual and dimensional examination. A random sample of instruments shall be selected from each lot offered to the Government in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The Acceptable Quality Levels (AQL) shall be as indicated in table I. The unit of product shall be one forceps.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

Type of Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major A	II	1.0
Major B	S-4	1.0
Minor A	II	4.0
Minor B	S-2	4.0

4.2.3 Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table II. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more tests characteristics. Unless otherwise specified, the unit of product for tests shall be one forceps.

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TABLE II. Sampling for tests.

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Forceps	Rockwell hardness	3.3.3	4.5.1	S-2	1.0
	Corrosion	3.3.4	4.5.2.1 & 4.5.2.2	S-2	1.0

4.2.4 Raw materials. A sufficient amount from each lot of each metal used in the construction of the instrument shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.3 Examination for visual and dimensional defects. The instrument shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables I and III. Examination however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table III. Any instrument in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected and if the number of defective instruments in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major A	
101	Style and design not as specified.
102	Instrument not constructed as specified.
103	Instrument not free from sharp edges, rough areas, burrs, cracks, grind marks or overlaps.
104	Serrations not free of foreign matter.
Major B	
151	Teeth not as specified.
152	Space or crevice between adjacent surfaces of junction.

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TABLE III. Classification of defects. (cont'd)

Categories	Defects
Minor A	
201	Finish not as specified.
202	Instrument not permanently and legibly marked with either the name or trademark of the contractor.
Minor B	
251	Physical dimensions not as specified.

4.4 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the preservation-packaging and interior package marking shall be in accordance with the group A and B quality conformance inspection requirements of MIL-P-116. The inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.5.1 Hardness. Rockwell hardness shall be determined in accordance with ASTM test method E18. A minimum of 5 hardness reading shall be made on test specimens representative of the material used in the fabrication of the instrument or on the finished instrument. Conversion of Vickers hardness values to Rockwell values shall be in accordance with ASTM Hardness Conversion Tables E140.

4.5.2 Corrosion tests.

4.5.2.1 Boil test. The instrument shall be subjected to the boil test as specified in GG-I-526.

4.5.2.2 Copper sulfate test. The instrument shall be subjected to the copper sulfate test as specified in GG-I-526.

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation-packaging. Preservation-packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Cleaning and drying. Each forcep shall be thoroughly cleaned and dried in accordance with the applicable process as outlined in MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.2 Preservative. Preservative shall not be applied.

5.1.1.3 Unit packaging. Each forceps shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other suitable anticorrosive material. Forceps shall be further packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method 1C-1.

5.1.1.4 Intermediate packaging. Twelve (12) forceps of type I or type II shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure of box shall be as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.1.2 Level C. Forceps shall be clean, dry and individually packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration and physical damage during shipment from supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Five hundrd seventy-six (576) forceps of type I, size 1 or two hundred eighty-eight (288) forceps of type II, size 1 or four hundred thirty-two (432) forceps of type II, size 2 shall be packed in a box designed for a type 2 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2 or PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, grade V3c. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard box shall be waterproof in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

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5.2.2 Level B. Five hundred seventy six (576) forceps of type I, size 1 or two hundred eighty-eight (288) forceps of type II, size 1 or four hundred thirty two (432) forceps of type II, size 2 shall be packed in a box designed for a type 2 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The packaged forceps shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the applicable carrier rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking. Each unit, intermediate package, and exterior container shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The forceps are to be used for grasping and holding tissue securely with minimum pressure and trauma in the practice of general and plastic surgery.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and the procurement documents should the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type and size (see 1.2.1).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) National Stock Number.

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the following items appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification	Type	Size
6515-00-584-3738	FORCEPS, TISSUE, TWEEZERS TYPE, Brown-Adson, 4-1/2 inch	I	1
6515-00-584-3739	FORCEPS, TISSUE, TWEEZERS TYPE, Brown, 8-inch	II	1
6515-00-584-3740	FORCEPS, TISSUE, TWEEZERS TYPE, Brown, 6-inch	II	2

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6.4 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet requirements.

Preparing activity:
DLA-DM
Project No. 6515-2044

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-F-37603 FORCEPS, TISSUE, BROWN AND BROWN-ADSON

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	MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A ☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

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   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

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